

STARTER UTTAR PRADESH

Palak Pakora

Signature starter from Uttar Pradesh, cooked without onion or garlic.

YIELD 4 portions	PORTION 1 portion	SERVICE Hot	TIME Prep 10 min - Cook 15 min
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Vegetarian | No onion | No garlic | No eggs | No meat | No fish | Vegan | Contains gluten
Cookware: Steel kadhai for frying - never aluminium

INGREDIENTS - 4 PORTIONS

QTY	UNIT	APPROX	INGREDIENT
250	g		spinach leaves
150	g		besan (gram flour)
1/2	tsp	~ 1.2 g	ajwain (carom seeds)
2	pieces	~ 16 g	green or dry red chillies
1/2	tsp	~ 1.2 g	hing (asafoetida)
1	tsp	~ 6 g	salt, or to taste
2	tbsp	~ 28 g	oil

METHOD

- Mise en place. Weigh every ingredient on this card for 4 portions. Set Steel kadhai for frying - never aluminium. Wash produce. Confirm spice blends have no onion or garlic powder. No onion, no garlic, no aluminium.
- Cut vegetables to even size so they cook together. Wash greens in several changes of water; drain and squeeze dry.
- Heat fat in Steel kadhai for frying - never aluminium on medium. Bloom hing 20-30 seconds until fragrant - this is the onion-garlic stand-in. Do not burn it.
- Dip leaves, fry in steel. Work in Steel kadhai for frying - never aluminium. Cook to the doneness below, tasting salt at the end. Do not add onion, garlic or aluminium cookware.
- Doneness: crust or crumb is set, centre is hot, no raw flour or potato taste. Drain on a steel rack, not paper in the fryer basket.
- Taste and adjust salt, lemon or chilli only - do not add onion or garlic at the finish. Garnish as listed. Yield is 4 portions.
- Hold hot above 63 C if the pass is delayed, or cool quickly and reheat once only to piping hot. Do not hold in aluminium. Service: Hot.

NUTRITION PER PORTION

KCAL 224	PROTEIN 10 g	CARBS 25 g	FAT 10 g	FIBRE 5 g
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Nutrition is a kitchen estimate from typical produce values, not a laboratory analysis.

ALLERGENS

- Gluten (wheat)
- Always verify labels; this card is a kitchen estimate, not a lab certificate.

CHEF NOTES

Wash greens until the water is clear; grit ruins the dish. For Palak Pakora: keep the mix slightly drier than you think; wet mixes split or go greasy. Bloom hing in hot fat 20-30 seconds; raw hing tastes medicinal. Commercial hing is often cut with wheat flour - use a

gluten-free hing if you must mark Gluten Free. Never cook tomato, tamarind, lemon, yogurt or milk in aluminium; use stainless steel, iron, clay or glass. Spice blends: read the packet. Many garam masalas hide onion or garlic powder. Cook or roast besan until the raw smell is gone.

SERVICE NOTES

Serve immediately while crisp or hot. Offer a chutney or raita that is also onion-garlic free. Service temperature: Hot. Allergen label for this dish: Gluten (wheat); Always verify labels; this card is a kitchen estimate, not a lab certificate. State clearly: vegetarian, no onion, no garlic, no eggs, no meat, no fish. Nutrition on this card is an estimate for 1 portion of 4.